

BLACKBIRD

Carleton University UAV Design Team

Sponsorship Package 2026-2027

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ABOUT US

Blackbird UAV is Carleton University's unmanned aerial vehicle design team! We are a student-run group that designs, builds, and flies drones with the goal of competing in the Aerial Evolution Association of Canada Student Competition (AEAC SC) every year, while also showcasing our UAV technology at expos and industry events.

Our team of over 100 members brings together students from various engineering disciplines and other fields, all united by a passion for aviation and innovation. Blackbird UAV gives students the chance to apply their classroom knowledge to real-world engineering challenges through hands-on drone design, testing, and flight.

Founded in 2009, Blackbird UAV has grown into one of Carleton University's most dynamic design teams, developing a fleet of drones that push the boundaries of aerial performance. Our UAVs have been featured at technology expos, public demonstrations, engineering showcases, and national competitions, proudly representing Carleton University wherever they fly.

Over the past 5 years, we have achieved three top 3 finishes at the AEAC student competition, a testament to the dedication, skill, and creativity of our team. We continue to push the boundaries of UAV design with modular payloads, FPV piloting, and innovative airframes, building on our success while preparing the next generation of aerospace and robotics innovators.

Recently, we expanded our team by joining the SAE Aero Design competition. This new endeavour challenges us to engineer a fixed-wing aircraft designed to optimize payload delivery and aerodynamic performance against top global university teams.





VEHICLES



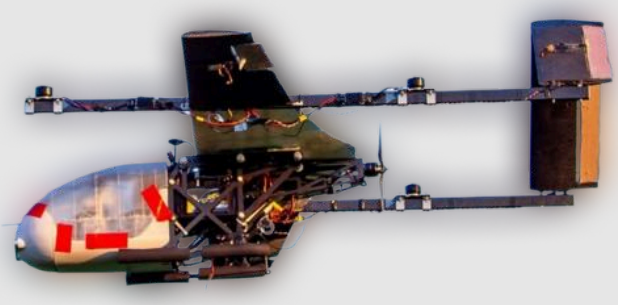
LEVIATHAN

Leviathan is engineered for urban firefighting, featuring a fully modular quadcopter architecture designed to support first responders through fire suppression, transport, and reconnaissance.

GOLIATH

Goliath is a quadcopter UAV with a fully modular payload system designed for forest firefighting and water delivery. It also features First-Person View (FPV) cameras, providing pilots with enhanced precision and control.



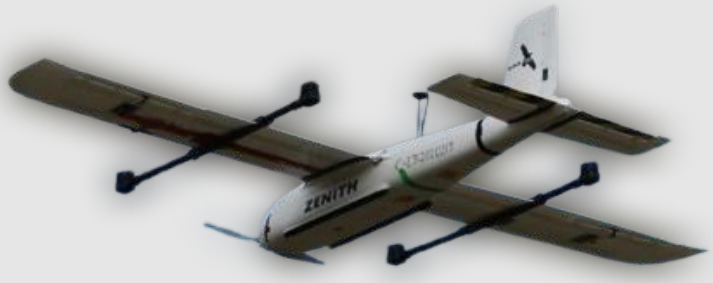


APOGEE

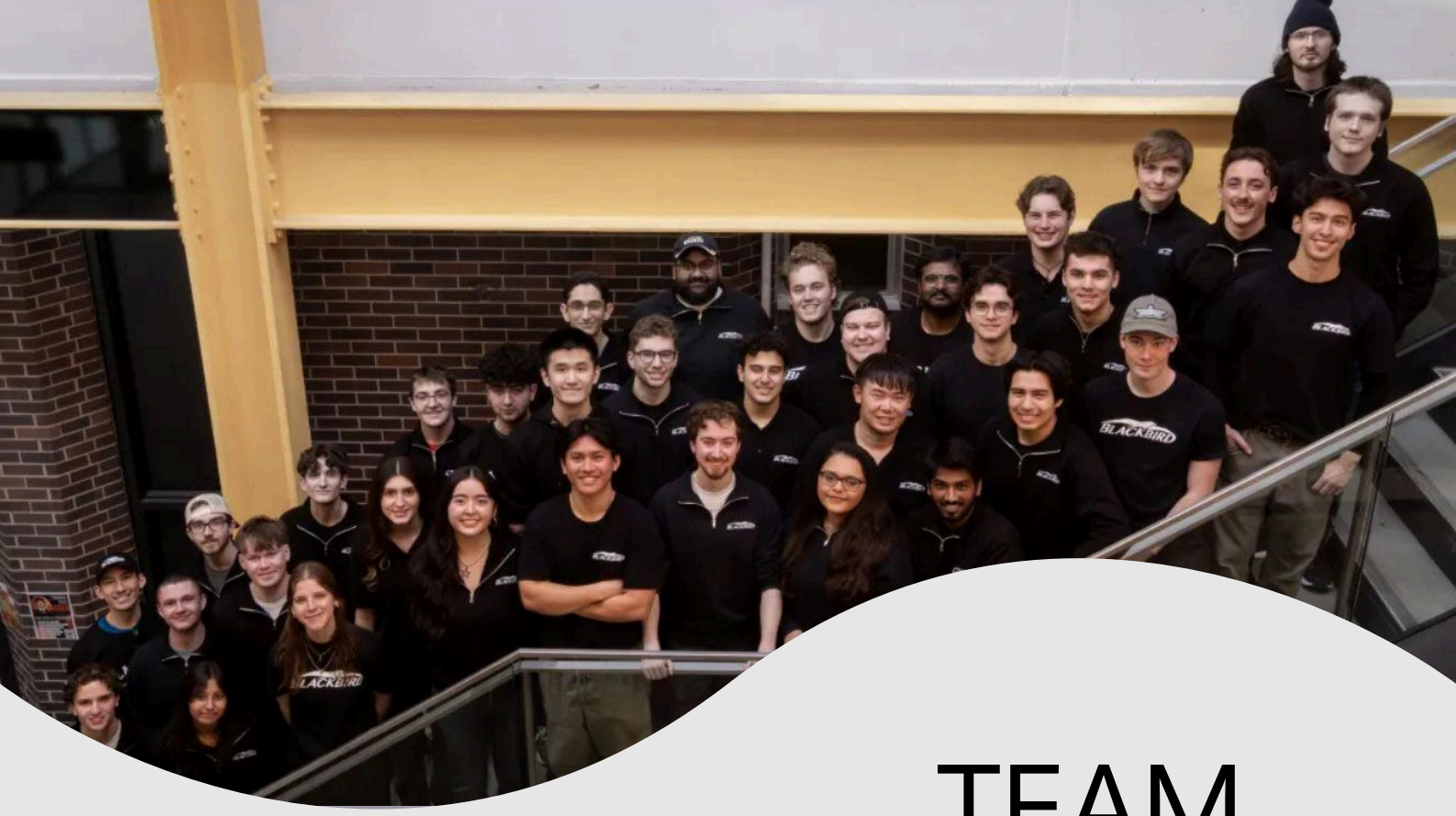
Apogee is a VTOL fixed wing showcasing our team's custom airframe design and integrated software systems. It features full autonomous flight capabilities, handling every phase from takeoff to landing.

ZENITH

Zenith is built for endurance, featuring advanced navigation systems and superior flight stability, making it ideal for long range missions. In 2023, it became the first BBUAV drone to incorporate LTE connectivity and VTOL transition capabilities.







TEAM

Our team members come from a wide range of disciplines, united by a shared passion for engineering and technology.

Our sub-teams, Mechanical, Electrical, Software, Operations, and Administration, work closely together across both our autonomous UAV and fixed-wing SAE Aero Design projects to ensure each project's success. We work in a collaborative environment rooted in teamwork, mentorship, and respect, giving students the opportunity to grow their technical abilities while building valuable leadership skills.

Team members contribute a wide range of expertise, including CAD, manufacturing, electronics, programming, systems integration, and project management, while gaining hands-on experience solving engineering challenges. Through Blackbird UAV, students grow as future leaders in aerospace and technology.

ACHIEVEMENTS

AEAC SC

1st place 2020

1st place 2023

Innovation 2024

3rd place 2025

Team Spirit 2026

First ever BVLOS signal relay drone

First ever VTOL transition

First ever fully LTE communications





OUTREACH

GCXpo

GCXpo is Canada's premier next-generation technology showcase. Co-hosted by Area X.O and the Government of Canada, the event features over 70 Canadian companies demonstrating cutting-edge technologies. The event provides a unique platform for invited guests, industry delegations, and media to engage with innovations preparing for global markets. Through live demos and guided tours, our team has the opportunity to showcase our UAV technologies to a wide, influential audience.



FED Fair

The Faculty of Engineering & Design (FED) Fair is held annually for Carleton University students and faculty. This event provides attendees with the opportunity to explore all clubs and societies within the faculty, alongside Expo Carleton, helping us connect with future engineering talent.

AEAC SC

The Aerial Evolution Association of Canada Student Competition (AEAC SC) is a national event that challenges university students to design, build, and operate UAVs for real-world applications. The competition draws attention from academia, industry professionals, and government organizations, making it one of the most recognized student showcases in Canada's UAV sector.

SAE AERO

The Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) Aero Design competition is an international collegiate event that challenges university students to conceive, design, fabricate, and test radio-controlled aircraft for real-world engineering applications. Organized by SAE International, the competition draws attention from academia, industry professionals, and government organizations, making it one of the most recognized student showcases in global aeronautics.



SPONSOR US

Partnering with Blackbird UAV provides your company with a direct pipeline to highly skilled engineering talent. Engineering companies are always on the lookout for strong candidates, and our team offers a dedicated talent pool ready for co-op, internship, and full-time positions. Through access to our member resume bank, your hiring team connects directly with students who have hands-on experience solving real-world engineering challenges. In addition to recruitment, partnering with us delivers direct brand exposure across our aircraft, team apparel, and digital media throughout the competition season. Sponsoring Blackbird UAV aligns your brand with technical innovation while giving your company a direct link to top emerging engineers.

Sponsoring Blackbird UAV gives students the chance to apply their engineering knowledge to real-world challenges, moving from design and manufacturing to autonomous systems integration and flight testing. Your support directly funds our participation in major engineering events, including the Aerial Evolution Association of Canada (AEAC) Student Competition and the Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) Aero Design Competition. Competing against top universities in these challenges requires advanced components and testing materials, which are made possible through sponsorship. Your support allows our team to innovate, learn, and grow while preparing the next generation of engineers. It keeps us at the forefront of student UAV development and fuels practical, hands-on learning.

If you are interested in sponsoring Blackbird UAV, please reach out to **sponsor@blackbirduav.ca** to start the sponsorship process and learn about next steps.

BENEFITS

	PARTNER $5000+	GOLD $3000+	SILVER $1000+	BRONZE $500+
Professional Recognition	●	●	●	●
Monthly Newsletters	●	●	●	●
Advertised on Team Website	●	●	●	●
Brand Placement on Aircraft	●	●	●	
Brand Placement on Team Apparel	Large	Medium	Small	
Brand Placement on Public Displays	●	●		
Promotional Material Distribution	●			

*All values in $CAD. Amount calculated as value donated or saved. Example: Donating $100 of components = $100 donation. Offering 20% off $100 = $20 donation. Donation amounts are reset each year on May 31st.

Thank you to last year's sponsors!

Carleton MAE

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